

Adam Cote

Adam-Cote.GitHub.io/Marco-Portfolio/

ACote23@WGU.edu / 701-509-0624

Cybersecurity and compliance professional with hands-on experience building and operating a full-cycle GRC program in a HIPAA-regulated environment — conducting internal control audits, maintaining control and risk registers, performing vendor risk assessments, tracking remediation to closure, and authoring compliance documentation aligned to HIPAA Security Rule, NIST 800-53, and NIST CSF v2.0 — with documented control mapping to SOC 2 Trust Services Criteria and ISO 27001 Annex A. Built and led the security and compliance function as sole practitioner across an 11-site clinic network, producing audit-ready deliverables for executive leadership across the full risk management lifecycle. Concurrently delivers multi-client compliance assessments across a 10-organization healthcare consortium, issuing formal gap reports with regulatory citations, risk-tiered findings, and remediation roadmaps. Seeking to bring internal audit discipline, multi-framework GRC experience, and documentation rigor to the GRC Analyst role at Marco Technologies.

Professional Experience

IT Security and Infrastructure Administrator
Northland Health Centers, Minot, ND

February 2025 - Present

- Built and operate the organization's GRC function as sole practitioner across an 11-site Federally Qualified Health Center - developing, implementing, and continuously monitoring security and compliance controls aligned to the HIPAA Security Rule and NIST CSF v2.0, with documented control mapping to NIST 800-53, SOC 2 Trust Services Criteria, and ISO 27001 Annex A control objectives.
- Conduct ongoing internal control audits and compliance monitoring reviews across endpoint, server, network, and cloud domains - evaluating security controls, configuration standards, and documented procedures against regulatory requirements and framework control objectives.
- Conducted an organization-wide HIPAA security risk assessment identifying critical control gaps (cleartext credentials, absent MFA, unencrypted PHI, flat network architecture); produced a formal risk matrix with likelihood and impact scoring mapped to specific HIPAA Security Rule citations; delivered a phased 0–7–30–90 day remediation roadmap to executive leadership and coordinated remediation to closure.
- Established and maintain the organizational risk register; provide guidance to control owners on exception requests, non-standard software approvals, and risk acceptance decisions balancing operational need against security and regulatory requirements.
- Established and maintain a third-party compliance assessment program covering vendor intake, BAA verification, sub-processor mapping, DNS/SSL certificate transparency forensics for data-flow validation, and post-deployment review — with formal compliance gap reports issued where coverage or PHI handling was deficient, citing regulatory authority and breach-clock analysis.
- Collect and organize compliance evidence for security control validation across all domains — including configuration documentation, audit log samples, policy attestations, and remediation artifacts — maintaining an audit-defensible evidence library aligned to HIPAA §164.312 requirements.
- Authored security policies, SOPs, and technical runbooks with change control, rollback procedures, and defined validation checklists — establishing documented, repeatable processes for phishing intake, EHR access with compensating controls, BitLocker deployment, AD CS renewal, and Windows Event Forwarding across all 11 sites.
- Participated in BCP and IRP development, testing, and updates — authoring the log review and incident detection policy with tiered escalation paths, eight anomaly thresholds, and a six-year retention schedule aligned to 45

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C.F.R. §164.316(b)(2); conducted a controlled password spray simulation to validate detection thresholds against live authentication event data.

- Investigated and formally closed security incidents — including a six-month SSL VPN password spray campaign (271 unique passwords against 16 accounts), characterized through packet capture and Windows Security Event log analysis — producing formal incident response reports, executive summaries, and management-facing metrics.
- Prepare and compile compliance reporting for management and security leadership, including remediation status tracking, control gap summaries, and incident metrics; respond to internal and external information requests regarding policies, procedures, and compliance posture.
- Independently validated the MDR provider's external attack surface assessment, identifying 9 exposed firewall management interfaces vs. 4 reported and confirming 2 devices reported as remediated remained publicly accessible — demonstrating independent audit discipline beyond vendor-supplied reporting.
- Built and maintain the HIPAA Security Awareness Program for ~80 users across 11 sites — developing scenario-based training content, recurring security briefings, and phishing reporting workflows; track employee compliance with issued programs.

Independent Compliance Consultant (Peer Engagements)

March 2026 - Present

Healthcare consortium, 10 federally qualified health centers; conducted on personal time

- Deliver multi-client compliance assessments to a 10-organization FQHC consortium — including WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility audits and HIPAA Notice of Privacy Practices (NPP) compliance reviews — issuing formal gap reports with regulatory citations, risk-tiered findings, and recommended remediation actions.
- Performed element-by-element NPP compliance audits across all 10 consortium organizations against 45 CFR §164.520; identified that 9 of 10 were substantially deficient; produced customized remediation templates and tracked active rulemaking and case law to ensure findings reflect current enforceable requirements.
- Built custom audit tooling to scale evidence collection and assessment delivery across multiple clients — including a Playwright + axe-core multi-viewport accessibility scanner with LLM-orchestrated triage and automated report generation, and a PowerShell-based CIS Benchmark control-testing framework producing per-machine audit spreadsheets and aggregated compliance reports.
- Maintained audit work-paper discipline including versioned deliverables, structured executive summaries with risk-tiered findings, and remediation timelines across all client engagements.

Information Systems & OT Electronics Technician

January 2017 - October 2024

Liberty Oilfield Services, Mid-Rockies Region

- Deployed and maintained integrated IT/OT network and control systems across multi-site oilfield operations, including sensors, radios, satellite links, and data acquisition platforms, minimizing downtime through component-level diagnostics and repairs

Tool Supervisor, Coordinator

October 2013 - January 2017

Thru Tubing Solutions, Minot, ND

Supervisor, Warehouse Dispatcher

September 2010 - October 2013

Pumpco Energy Services, Minot, ND

Airframe and Powerplant Mechanic (Crew Chief)

September 2006 - September 2010

United States Air Force, Minot AFB, ND

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Certifications

SecurityX (Formerly CASP+), <i>CompTIA</i>	April 2026
Pentest+, <i>CompTIA</i>	March 2026
Cybersecurity Analyst+ (CySA+), <i>CompTIA</i>	September 2025
Security+ Certification, <i>CompTIA</i>	September 2025
Network+ Certification, <i>CompTIA</i>	October 2025
A+ Certification, <i>CompTIA</i>	April 2025

Pending Exams

CHPS (Certified in HIPAA Privacy and Security), <i>AHIMA</i>	May 2026
CISM (Exam Summer 2026), <i>ISACA</i>	Summer 2026
SecAI (Exam Summer 2026), <i>CompTIA</i>	July 2026
CISA (Exam Fall 2026), <i>ISACA</i>	Fall 2026

Education

Master of Science in Cybersecurity and Information Assurance <i>Western Governors University, Salt Lake City, UT</i>	April 2026
Bachelor of Science in Aviation Maintenance Technology <i>Thomas Edison State University, Trenton, New Jersey</i>	December 2022
Associate in Science in Electronics Systems Engineering Technology <i>Thomas Edison State University, Trenton, New Jersey</i>	December 2022

Skills

GRC Frameworks & Standards: HIPAA Security Rule, HIPAA Privacy Rule, HITECH, 42 CFR Part 2, NIST 800-53, NIST 800-171, NIST CSF v2.0, CIS Controls v8, MITRE ATT&CK, WCAG 2.1 AA, SOC 2 Trust Services Criteria (familiarity), ISO 27001 (familiarity), PCI DSS (academic familiarity)

Compliance & Audit Operations: Internal control audits, compliance monitoring reviews, gap assessments, control evaluation, audit evidence collection and organization, risk assessment and scoring, risk register maintenance, third-party and vendor compliance review, BAA review, remediation tracking, exception management, compliance documentation development (policies, procedures, SOPs, risk assessments, system descriptions), BCP/DRP/IRP support, executive and committee reporting, customer information request responses

Security Operations: MDR alert triage, incident investigation and documentation, log analysis (Windows Security, Microsoft Entra), phishing triage, external attack surface review, vulnerability validation

Cloud & Identity: Microsoft 365, Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Azure MFA, Active Directory, Group Policy, AD CS / PKI

Endpoint & Infrastructure: Windows Server 2019, Hyper-V, BitLocker, NinjaOne RMM, SonicWall, NPS/RADIUS, RRAS VPN, Windows Event Forwarding

Tooling & Scripting: PowerShell, Python, Wireshark, VirusTotal, ANY.RUN, Playwright + axe-core